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The Mystery of the Sphinx

The Great Sphinx is an intriguing icon of Ancient Egypt. This giant statue has the body of a lion and the head of a man. It stands in the desert near pyramids that are also huge. Most scientists believe the Great Sphinx is about four thousand years old. This is the same age as the pyramids. But the Sphinx has no writing indicating who built it or when. Could the Sphinx be older?

Over the ages, the stone body of the Sphinx has worn away. Its beard is gone, and its nose is missing. Some scientists believe that water was the cause of the erosion. Their theory is that people built the Sphinx during an earlier time when Egypt was much wetter. They think the Sphinx was built thousands of years before the pyramids were built. But many skeptics do not agree with this theory. The true age of the Great Sphinx of Egypt is still a mystery.